

FINANCIAL FORECASTING

DEFINITION OF RECURSIVE ALGORITHMS:

Recursion is the technique of making a function call itself. This technique provides a way to break complicated problems down into simpler problems which are easier to solve.

EXAMPLE: Addition of n numbers by using Recursion

```
public class Main {  
  
    public static int sum(int k) {  
  
        if (k > 0) {  
  
            return k + sum(k - 1);  
  
        } else {  
  
            return 0;  
  
        }  
  
    }  
  
    public static void main(String[] args) {  
  
        int result = sum(5);  
  
        System.out.println(result);  
  
    }  
  
}
```

Explanation:

Intially k = 5

It enters if block $5 > 0$, it return $5 + \text{sum}(5-1)$

for $\text{sum}(4)$ it enters to the methods in if block $4 > 0$ then it returns $4 + \text{sum}(4-1)$

for $\text{sum}(3)$ it enters to the methods in if block $3 > 0$ then it returns $3 + \text{sum}(3-1)$

for $\text{sum}(2)$ it enters to the methods in if block $2 > 0$ then it returns $2 + \text{sum}(2-1)$

for sum(1) it enters to the methods in if block $1 > 0$ then it returns $1 + \text{sum}(1-1)$

for sum(0) it enters to the methods in if block $0 = 0$ then it returns 0

so $\text{sum}(1) = 1 + 0 = 1$

$\text{sum}(2) = 2 + 1 = 3$

$\text{sum}(3) = 3 + 3 = 6$

$\text{sum}(4) = 4 + 6 = 10$

$\text{sum}(5) = 5 + 10 = 15$

so it return 15 to main class calling area and prints 15

TIME COMPLEXITY:

In my Financial Forecasting solution, for every call creates an another call which takes $O(n)$ time .

But if it extended to branching recursion like multiple investment then it becomes $O(2^n)$ or worse.

Problem with simple recursion

- Recalculates same values again and again
- Very slow for large inputs

OPTIMIZATION TECHNIQUES:

To Optimize the recursion time complexity, store the already computed values in an array so that it takes lesser time than simple recursion. This method is call as Memoization.